sama

IMPACT REPORT 2024-25



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Message from the Team

As I write this, I realize how much there is to share. Sama began as a direct response to a need we saw on the ground—bridging the digital divide while tackling e-waste. The challenge is ambitious, but we've approached it one step at a time, learning and evolving along the way.

What has kept me going from Day 1 is the support of people like you—who believed in this vision and contributed wholeheartedly to making it happen. Because of this collective effort, we've been able to repurpose 4131 laptops into powerful learning tools, empowering individuals who would otherwise be left behind.

While we've made progress, there is still much more to do. The demand for digital access continues to grow, and with it, the urgency to scale our impact. Your continued support and encouragement will be crucial as we move forward. Here's to many more milestones together in 2025!

– **Manisha**

As we step into 2025, I feel an overwhelming sense of pride and gratitude for everything we've achieved together. In August, we started with a vision to support women and youth facing the same challenge I encountered during my graduation—a lack of access to digital devices. This digital divide limits them from reaching their full learning potential.

This realization motivated me to take action and work towards bridging this gap. Our efforts have been dedicated to empowering women and youth by providing them with the digital tools they need to succeed. Together, we are not just distributing devices; we are enabling dreams, unlocking opportunities, and shaping a more inclusive future.

– **Nitesh**

Who Are We

Sama, an initiative of NavGurukul, is a non-profit that bridges the digital divide by repurposing e-waste to empower underserved women and youth through access to technology. Founded with the mission to enable equitable opportunities, Sama collects end-of-life laptops from corporates and refurbishes them, giving them a second life as tools for education, skill-building, and socioeconomic transformation to those underserved communities where usually the eyes of the public do not fall upon.

Problem We Target



India is the world's third-largest e-waste producer, generating 2 million tons annually, with 70% of this waste coming from discarded laptops.



80% of e-waste is processed informally, causing severe environmental and health hazards.



There is a **29% gap in digital infrastructure** between urban and rural schools, further widening the digital divide.



83% of urban population have internet access, while only **48% of rural populations do, limiting** education, employment, and essential services.



The **digital gender divide remains significant**, with only 32% of rural users reliably accessing digital platforms for banking, education, and healthcare, compared to 81% in urban areas.

We are at the **tip of the problem**, but there is still **much more to be done** to ensure **true digital inclusion and lasting impact**.

Our Impact

Since its inception, Sama has impacted over 1,50,000 lives, fostering a culture of sustainability and inclusion. By transforming obsolete devices into catalysts for change, we are helping create a future where technology becomes an enabler of progress for all, regardless of socioeconomic background.

159810
Beneficiaries Impacted

81548
Females Reached

1200
Schools Reached

PAN India
Regions Covered

4131
Laptops Distributed

159810
Beneficiaries Impacted

Direct Beneficiaries

- Students
- Job Seekers & Professionals
- Women & Youth from Underserved Communities
- Master's & Higher Education Aspirants

Indirect Beneficiaries

- Families & Siblings
- Local Communities & Villages
- Chain Reaction Effect - Multiple individuals can use laptops over time, leading to long-term generational upliftment.

Environmental Impact



Reducing E-Waste

Less than 20% of e-waste is formally recycled, with 80% either ending up in landfill or being informally recycled. By repurposing laptops, Sama prevents electronic waste from entering landfills, reducing toxic pollution and conserving valuable resources.



Lowering Carbon Footprint

By refurbishing a laptop instead of manufacturing a new one, we prevent approximately 316 kg of CO_2 emissions from being released into the environment. This sustainable approach not only extends the device's lifespan but also significantly reduces the carbon footprint, contributing to a greener future.



Tree Plantation

For our tree plantation efforts, we use a 'green browser' as our search engine, which has facilitated the planting of 486 trees which is equivalent to covering an entire football field in a span of only 4 months.

Success Stories



My journey with NavGurukul began as a student after completing my 12th, where I gained the skills and knowledge that laid the foundation for my career. Thanks to Sama, I received a laptop that was pivotal in supporting my studies and growth, ultimately leading to my role as a Frontend Developer at Accenture. I'm deeply grateful to NavGurukul and Sama for empowering my education and professional development.

– Ruchi



I am studying in 7th grade at MR Nagar Higher Primary School and am the eldest child in my family. Economically, we struggle, and my parents cannot afford the ₹5000 fee for a computer class in town. In school, we learn only from textbooks, but my neighbor and friend Ankitha, who attends a private school called SJM, has access to computer education as part of her curriculum. I often wondered why basic computer skills are not taught in our school as well. Thanks to Sama and Vimukthi Vidya Samsthe for providing computers in rural areas, allowing us to learn and grow. I am truly grateful for this opportunity.

- Alfiya



Sama and NavGurukul have played a pivotal role in helping me secure this job by providing me with a laptop that enabled me to pursue my studies and enhance my skills. The placement support offered played a key part in helping me find the right opportunity. I am incredibly grateful for the guidance, resources, and support they provided, which have been invaluable in shaping my career and enabling me to succeed at Amazon.

- Sonam

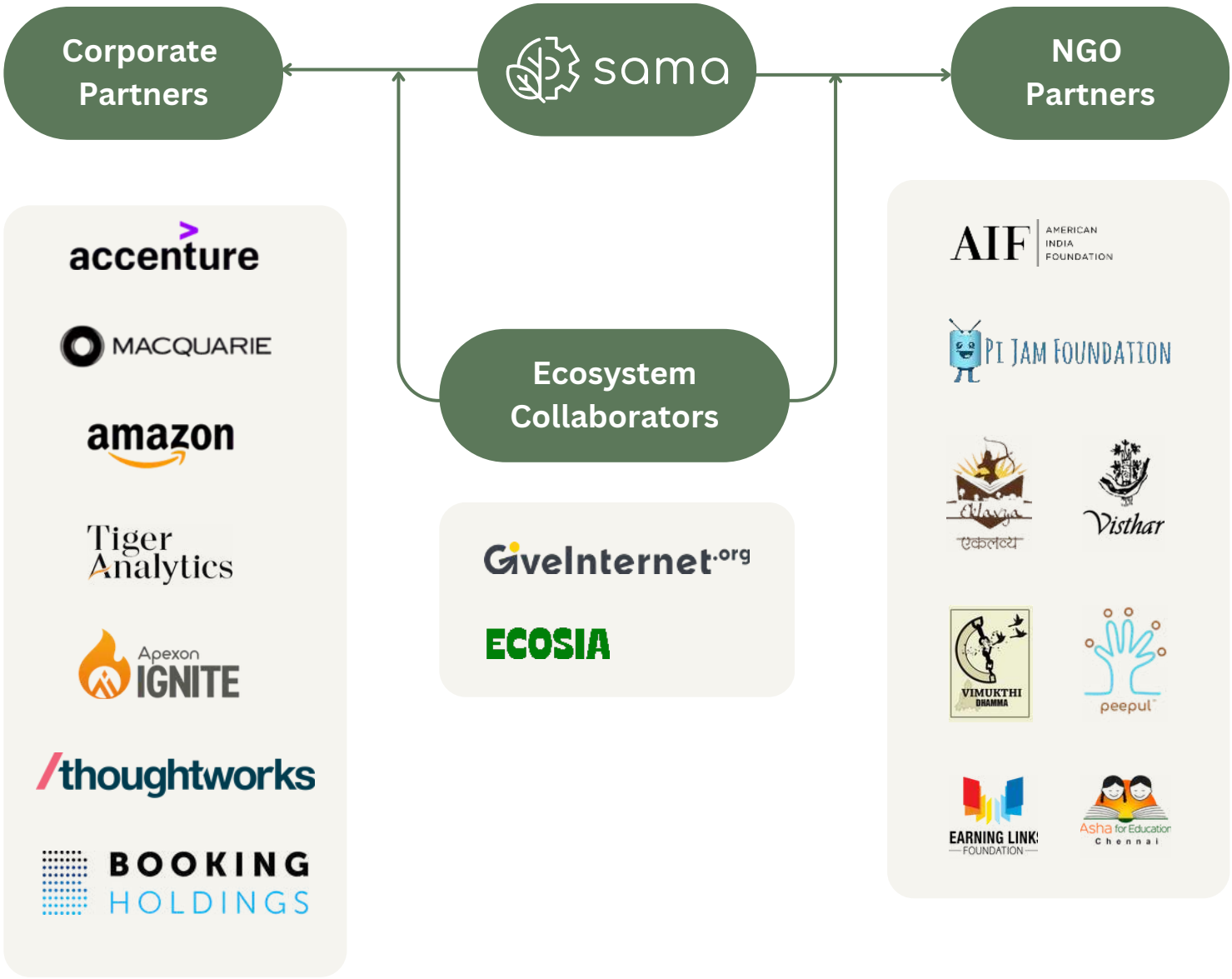


I lost my mother when I was just three months old, and later that same year, my father left me. I was raised by my grandmother, but she passed away when I was six. Since then, I have been living with my relatives, my uncles and aunts. Currently, I am studying in 9th grade at Badra Prouda Shale, MK Hatty in Chitradurga. I have always wanted to learn and educate myself, but financial constraints made it impossible for me to afford skill development programs. My life changed when Nagarathna Ma'am identified me, and for the first time, I stepped into the computer center of Vimukthi Vidya Samsthe. It was the first time I touched and experienced a computer. Thank you, Sama, for this opportunity.

- Apoorva

Spreading Our Impact

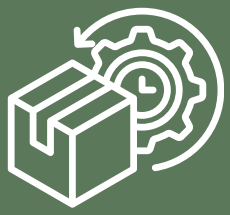
By working closely with corporate donors, NGOs, and ecosystem collaborators, we amplify the impact of our initiatives and ensure that refurbished devices reach the hands of those who can benefit most. Each collaboration is a step towards creating a more inclusive and sustainable society.



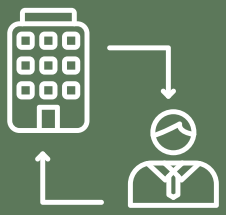
Challenges & Learnings



We aim to onboard **100 companies** for recurring donations in the coming year, many of our major corporate donors operate within SEZs, where we are exploring ways to optimize the donation process. We are actively working to streamline these contributions and ensure a seamless flow of support.



Sustainability and **cost-effective** logistics remain to be essential elements for long-term scalability.



While we initially focused on shared laptops and labs, we now recognize the importance of personal device access as well. We want to establish a **D2C (Direct-to-Consumer) model,** ensuring individuals have direct access to refurbished laptops for independent learning and growth.

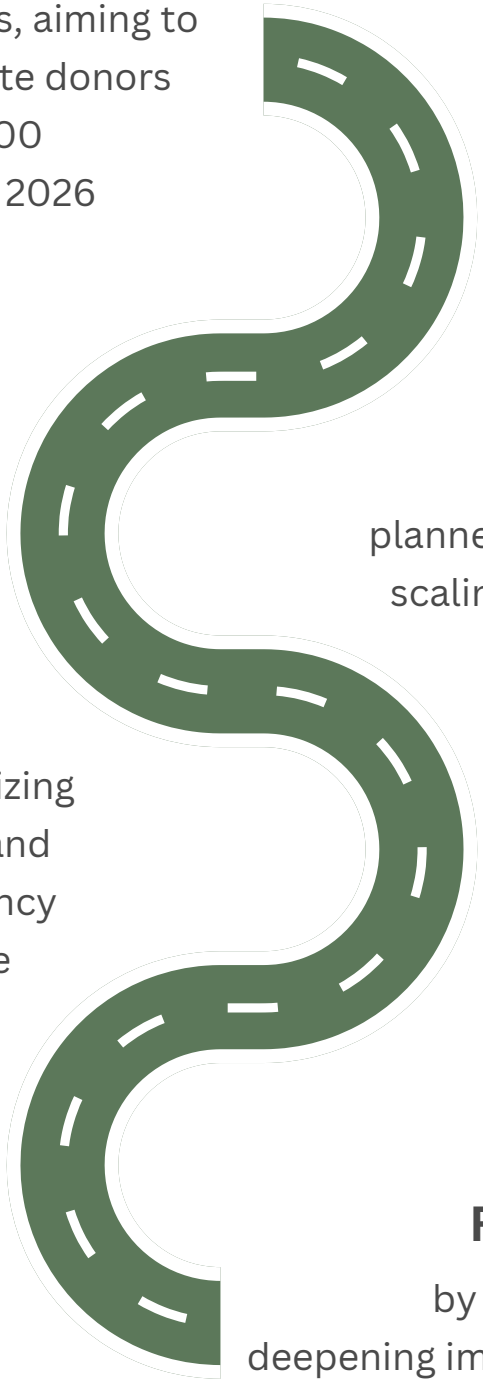


We feel that laptops offer more than just digital access. We are working to understand **students' actual needs and build an ecosystem** where technology drives real educational and career advancements.

Future Roadmap

50% Increase

in corporate partnerships, aiming to onboard 50 new corporate donors by 2025 and expand to 100 additional corporates by 2026



10,000 Laptops

planned to be distributed in 2025, scaling up to 25,000 refurbished laptops in 2026

30% Reduction

in cost per laptop by optimizing collection, refurbishment, and distribution through efficiency improvements and in-house recycling

Reaching More States

by growing our presence while deepening impact within existing regions by expanding to more pin codes within the same states

Photo Gallery











Photo Gallery





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Thank You

